

WHAT'S DONE

- India constructed 13,298 km of highways in 2020–21 despite the pandemic and lockdown
- Rs 1.99 lakh crore allocated to the ministry in Budget 2022
- Sanctioned highway projects worth Rs 3.36 lakh crore during the three years up to 2020–21
- Directed officials to work overtime to clear pending dues to contractors and speed up project approvals, project delivery and implementation
- Emergence of greenfield expressways in the past few years, a shift from expanding existing highways such as Delhi–Mumbai and Delhi–Amritsar–Katra

CHALLENGES AHEAD

- NHAI's cumulative debt rose from Rs 44,567 crore in 2015–16 to Rs 3.17 lakh crore by the end of 2020–21
- Finance ministry strictures state NHAI cannot borrow any more but monetise assets to fund highway construction
- Pace of monetisation slow—Gadkari says 5,500 km of highways will be up for monetisation in 2022–23
- Private sector investment in road construction Rs 15,164.25 crore till November 2021
- Indian roads remain among the unsafest in the world, with India heading the list in road accident deaths across 199 countries

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